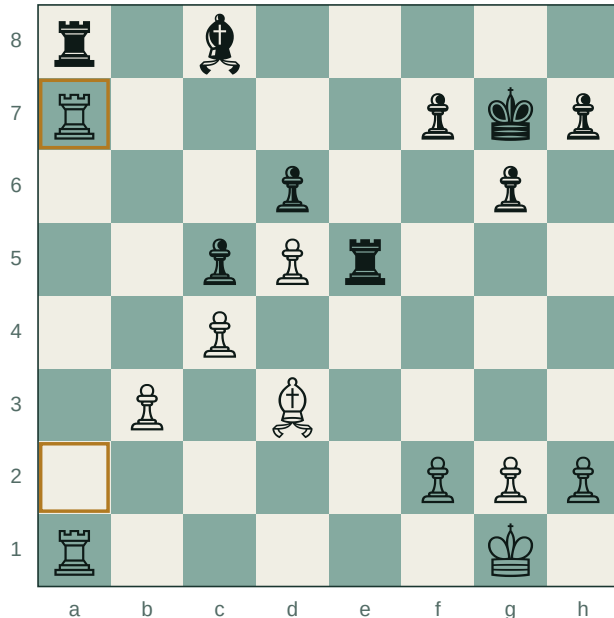


Active defensive resources: Black, move 24

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 24.Rxa7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24...Rxa7 25. Rxa7 Re1+ 26. Bf1 Bf5

24...Rxa7 The rook captures the rook on a7. Recorded reply: **25.Rxa7**.

25...Re1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **26.Bf1**.

26...Bf5 The bishop moves from c8 to f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +0:** the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d3. Check for tactical protection.